

Essay Type	Purpose	Structure	Thesis Statement Style	Example Thesis Statement	Special Features
Critical Response	Analyze and evaluate a text	Intro with summary, thesis, body with evidence, conclusion	Claim + 3 Supporting Points (Evaluation stance)	<i>In “Why We Crave Horror Movies” Stephen King effectively uses conversational language, vivid metaphors, and personal anecdotes to engage readers.</i>	Engages directly with a text (quotes, references, author name)
Narrative	Tell a personal or fictional story	Intro, Rising Action, Climax, Falling Action, Resolution	Lesson + 3-part story arc	<i>Overcoming my failure in the science fair helped me become resilient by teaching me to embrace setbacks, plan future projects, and accept the value of support.</i>	Uses storytelling elements (dialogue, sensory details, flashbacks)
Descriptive	Describe a scene, object, or person vividly	Intro, 3 body paras focused on sensory details, conclusion	Focus + 3 Vivid Descriptive Aspects	<i>Lahore’s old bazaar being a cultural heart of the city, is a place of vibrant color, mouthwatering smells, and rich cultural texture.</i>	Heavy on sensory language and figurative expressions
Personal Statement	Showcase yourself for academic/professional purpose	Intro, body (academic, personal, future), conclusion	Purpose + Skill 1 + Skill 2 + Skill 3	<i>I aim to contribute to growing field e-sports through programming skills, leadership, and innovative game design.</i>	Blends academic + personal + future outlook
Argumentative	Convince the reader of a stance	Intro (hook + background + thesis), 3 paras (counter, strongest, second), conclusion	Counter Argument + Claim + Reason 1 + Reason 2	<i>Though some argue social media connects us, it harms real communication by reducing attention span and fostering superficial relationships.</i>	Requires a counterargument and evidential reasoning (researched facts)

Essay Type	Primary Purpose	Reader's Hook Strategy	Example of Hook
Critical Response	Evaluate and analyze a text	Contextual Background of the Text (title, author, year, context, relevance today)	<i>Published in 1949, George Orwell's "1984" offers a chilling vision of surveillance that still resonates in the digital age.</i>
Narrative	Tell a personal or fictional story	Anecdote, Flashback, Dramatic moment, Dialogue, or Sensory Description	<i>"You'll never make it," my coach whispered. That moment stayed with me longer than any victory ever did.</i>
Descriptive	Vividly describe a person, place, or event	Vivid Sensory Detail, Metaphor, Zoom-in technique, Rhetorical question	<i>What color is silence? In the snow-covered valley, it gleamed silver beneath a cloudless sky.</i>
Personal Statement	Showcase one's background, goals, and skills	Anecdote, Rhetorical Question, Interesting Fact, or Quotation	<i>How can failure become your greatest teacher? For me, it began with a missed scholarship.</i>
Argumentative	Persuade with logic and evidence	Rhetorical Question, Statistic, Anecdote, or Controversial Statement	<i>What if the very platforms meant to connect us are tearing us apart?</i>

Personal Statement Writing Guidelines(See the Provided Sample)

Paragraph Structure & Length

- If your personal statement is **350–400 words**, each paragraph should be approximately **70–80 words**.
- Write around **6–8 sentences per paragraph**.
- Maintain clear paragraph division:
 1. Introduction
 2. Academic Achievements
 3. Personal Experiences/Skill Development
 4. Future Goals
 5. Conclusion

Introductory Paragraph Breakdown

1. Reader's Hook (1–2 sentences)

- Begin with an engaging opening:
 - Anecdote
 - Interesting observation
 - Striking fact
 - Personal realization

- o Rhetorical question
- The hook should reflect:
 - o your personality
 - o passion
 - o curiosity
 - o motivation
- If using an anecdote, avoid revealing the full lesson immediately.

2. Lead-In (1–2 sentences)

- Introduce:
 - o your academic interest
 - o career aspiration
 - o inspiration for choosing the field
- Connect the hook naturally to your purpose.

3. Thesis Statement (1 sentence only)

Clearly mention:

- your purpose/career goal
- three abilities, qualities, or skills that support your purpose

Your three supporting points may come from:

- Academic achievements
- Personal experiences
- Leadership/community involvement
- Future ambitions

Write the supporting points using:

- verb + noun phrases

OR

- adjectival phrases

Example Pattern:

I aim to contribute to ____ through developing ____, demonstrating ____, and promoting ____.

4. Transitional Hook (1 sentence only)

- End the introduction with a sentence leading toward the body paragraphs.
- Include **two controlling ideas** that hint at upcoming discussion.

Example:

My passion for technology continues to shape both my creativity and analytical thinking.

Body Paragraph Guidelines

Body Paragraph 1 — Academic Achievements

Purpose:

Explain how your:

- studies
- projects
- subjects
- competitions
- achievements

helped you develop an important skill.

Structure:

1. Topic sentence with 2 controlling ideas
2. Major detail/example
3. Minor detail/explanation
4. Transitional hook leading to next paragraph

Focus On:

- analytical thinking
- academic discipline
- innovation
- creativity
- technical understanding

Body Paragraph 2 — Personal Experiences & Skill Development

Purpose:

Explain how:

- hobbies
- teamwork
- leadership
- challenges
- extracurricular activities
- volunteer experiences

helped shape your personality and skills.

Structure:

1. Topic sentence with 2 controlling ideas
2. Major experience/example
3. Minor detail/explanation
4. Transitional hook leading to future goals

Focus On:

- leadership
- communication
- teamwork
- resilience
- confidence
- problem-solving

Body Paragraph 3 — Future Goals

Purpose:

Explain:

- your future ambitions
- contribution to society
- long-term career goals
- impact you hope to create

Structure:

1. Topic sentence with 2 controlling ideas
2. Major future goal
3. Explanation of social/academic impact
4. Final reflective statement

Focus On:

- innovation
- social contribution
- technological advancement
- research
- community impact

Conclusion Paragraph

Structure:

1. Restate your purpose and passion clearly.
2. Re-emphasize your three major qualities/goals.

3. Express enthusiasm for the program/opportunity.
4. End with a memorable final thought connected to the introduction.

Important:

- Do not introduce completely new ideas.
- Keep the tone confident, hopeful, and reflective.

Formatting Reminder

1. Underline the following:
 - o Thesis statement
 - o Topic sentences
 - o Controlling ideas
 - o Transitional hooks
2. Read the prompt carefully before writing.
3. Understand:
 - o What the university/program is asking
 - o Which qualities should be highlighted
4. Construct your thesis statement in rough first to ensure:
 - o parallel structure
 - o clarity
 - o logical flow
5. Plan controlling ideas before writing body paragraphs.
6. Use synonyms while repeating ideas in:
 - o topic sentences
 - o transitional hooks
 - o conclusion
7. Maintain:
 - o formal tone
 - o clarity
 - o coherence
 - o specific examples
8. Avoid:
 - o overly general statements
 - o repetition

- o very casual language
 - o unsupported claims
 - 9. Show personality through:
 - o reflections
 - o motivations
 - o experiences
 - o future vision
 - 10. Ensure all paragraphs remain connected logically through transitions.
- Argumentative essay Sample.pptx
Presentation
- do the same for argumentative essay, by looking ta the sample attached

Argumentative Essay Writing Guidelines (See the Provided Sample)

Paragraph Structure & Length

- If your argumentative essay is **350–400 words**, each paragraph should be approximately **70–80 words**.
- Write around **6–8 sentences per paragraph**.
- Organize the essay into:
 1. Introduction
 2. Counterargument Paragraph
 3. Supporting Argument 1
 4. Supporting Argument 2
 5. Conclusion

Introductory Paragraph Breakdown

1. Reader's Hook (1–2 sentences)

- Begin with an engaging opening:
 - o Anecdote
 - o Short scenario
 - o Surprising fact
 - o Observation
 - o Rhetorical question
- The hook should create curiosity and connect naturally to the topic.

2. Lead-In (1–2 sentences)

- Introduce the issue or debate.
- Briefly explain why the topic is important or relevant.
- Connect the hook to the thesis smoothly.

3. Thesis Statement (1 sentence only)

Your thesis must include:

- the counterargument briefly
- your stance/claim
- two supporting reasons

Thesis Pattern:

Although ____ (counterargument), ____ (your argument) because ____ (reason 1) and ____ (reason 2).

Important:

- Keep the thesis clear and direct.
- Maintain parallel structure.
- Mention only two supporting reasons if writing two supporting body paragraphs.

4. Transitional Hook (1 sentence only)

- End the introduction with a sentence leading toward the counterargument paragraph.
- Include two controlling ideas connected to the counterargument.

Example:

Although many people consider social media distracting and harmful, it still remains an important communication tool.

Body Paragraph 1 — Counterargument Paragraph

Purpose:

Present the opposing viewpoint fairly before refuting it.

Structure:

1. Topic sentence presenting counterargument with 2 controlling ideas
2. Major details/examples supporting opposing view
3. Minor details/explanation
4. Refutation sentence
5. Transitional hook leading toward your argument

Important Notes:

- Use **3rd person perspective**:
 - critics argue
 - many people believe
 - some individuals claim
- Refute politely and logically.

DO NOT:

- use emotional attacks
- mock the opposing side
- use ethos, pathos, or logos labels explicitly in this paragraph

Body Paragraph 2 — Supporting Argument 1**Purpose:**

Present your first supporting reason.

Structure:

1. Topic sentence with 2 controlling ideas
2. Major detail/example
3. Supporting explanation
4. Transitional hook leading to next paragraph

Focus On:

- explanation
- evidence
- examples
- logical connection to thesis

Use any of these:

- Ethos
- Pathos
- Logos

to strengthen the argument.

Body Paragraph 3 — Supporting Argument 2

Purpose:

Present your second supporting reason.

Structure:

1. Topic sentence with 2 controlling ideas
2. Major detail/example
3. Minor explanation
4. Final reflective statement or implication

Focus On:

- strong examples
- practical impact
- real-world relevance
- persuasive explanation

Conclusion Paragraph

Structure:

1. Restate your thesis clearly.
2. Briefly mention the two supporting reasons again.
3. Reinforce why your argument is stronger than the counterargument.
4. End with a memorable closing statement or takeaway message.

Important:

- Do not introduce new arguments.
- Keep the conclusion concise and impactful.

Formatting Reminder

1. Underline the following in your essay:
 - o Thesis statement
 - o Topic sentences
 - o Transitional hooks
 - o Controlling ideas

2. Read the prompt carefully before writing.
3. Clearly identify:
 - o the issue
 - o your stance
 - o the opposing viewpoint
4. Construct your thesis statement in rough first to ensure:
 - o parallel structure
 - o clarity
 - o balance between argument and counterargument
5. Plan:
 - o two supporting reasons
 - o two controlling ideas for each paragraph
6. Use synonyms while repeating ideas across:
 - o thesis
 - o topic sentences
 - o conclusion
7. Use:
 - o formal tone
 - o logical reasoning
 - o clear transitions
 - o relevant examples
8. Avoid:
 - o emotional exaggeration
 - o repetition
 - o informal expressions
 - o unsupported claims
9. Ensure each paragraph connects logically to the next through transitional hooks.
10. Keep your argument focused, balanced, and persuasive throughout the essay.

Paraphrasing Guidelines:

Criterion	Exceeds Expectations	Meets Expectations	Below Expectations
Points earned	3	2	1
Main Idea	Main idea is clear	Main idea is hinted on	Main idea is incorrect
Detail	Relevant detail included	Some relevant detail missing	Too many or no details
Paraphrase	sentence and word order changed	Some sentences put into own words	Sentence copied from text
Grammar	Sentence structure is varied	Sentence structure is simple	No change in Sentence structure
Spelling /punctuation	1.5 No spelling/ punctuation errors	1.0 some spelling/ punctuation errors	0.5 Many spelling/ punctuation errors
References	1.5 Accurate use	1.0 Partly accurate use	0.5 Incorrect/missing references

1. Main Idea (3 marks)

- Clearly identify and restate the central idea of the original text in your own words.
- Avoid altering the meaning or focus of the original statement.
- Ensure the paraphrased version conveys the same core message.

2. Supporting Detail (3 marks)

- Include all significant supporting information that reinforces the main idea.
- Do not omit key concepts or overgeneralize.
- Ensure that the paraphrased version reflects the full intent of the original message.

3. Paraphrasing Technique (3 marks)

- Demonstrate substantial changes to both the **wording** and **sentence structure**.

- Avoid copying phrases directly from the original; use synonyms where appropriate.
- Rearrange sentence elements to reflect a unique construction while preserving meaning.

4. Grammar and Sentence Variety (3 marks)

- Use grammatically correct sentences with appropriate punctuation.
- Incorporate a mix of sentence structures (simple, compound, and complex) to enhance clarity and flow.
- Maintain subject-verb agreement, proper verb tenses, and logical sentence connections.

5. Spelling and Punctuation (1.5 marks)

- Ensure your work is free of spelling, punctuation, and capitalization errors.
- Proofread your work before submission.

6. Reference Use (1.5 marks)

- Accurately cite the source of the original idea using in-text citation format (e.g., *Reuben, 2005*).
- Ensure reference details are complete and correctly formatted, if applicable.

Guidelines for Critical Response Questions:

1. Understand the Question Type: Identify if it's interpretive, analytical, evaluative, contextual, or reflective. **(do not mention the type of question while you are writing the answer)**
2. Directly Address the Prompt: Restate or paraphrase the question to stay focused.
3. Support with Evidence: Use quotes, paraphrases, or specific examples from the passage. (“the concept of happiness.....mutual”)
4. Offer Insight or Interpretation: Explain why the evidence matters.
5. Be Clear and Concise: Use 5–6 well-structured sentences.

6. Use Academic Language: Employ precise verbs and logical connectors.
7. Stay Within Scope: Avoid unrelated information. (See Revision Slides for sample answers)

All the best — follow the structure, be precise, and reflect deeply on your experiences!